

IS THE FUTURE MICRO-SOCIAL?

We take a look at how kids born today will use the internet in the future



Playing soothsayer is everyone's favourite pastime because lifting the burden of accuracy from a writer's shoulders is so very liberating. However, it's not like there's been any accuracy to speak of in today's global journalism anyway... And that's where this story begins for us. When this magazine started 20 years ago if we'd told you that a time would come when we'd all have a computer in our pocket and be divided up and monetised by companies preying on our inherent biases, your immediate reaction would be to laugh hysterically... "A computer in your pocket? What a ridiculous concept!" That second bit about biases and the powers that be dividing us and finding ways to monetise us would, of course, not be a shock to anyone. It's how it's always been, and perhaps how it always will be. Controlling people has always been the aim of those who lust for wealth and power.

Another thing that always will hold true is generation after generation, young ones will find something new to do and break the mold, while us old fogies will shake our heads at them in disbelief, and try and corner them all to tell them stories that inevitably contain the phrase, "Back in my day...". And what makes someone an "old fogie" you ask? It's certainly not just age anymore. It's being set in one's ways and not going with the flow. What technology and the internet has done is make generations shorten to as little as five years now. Yes, the average 13-year-old is already using the internet in a very different way than the average 18-year-old, while a 23-year-old is already past his or her prime and should just be set out to pasture – sent off into the *ugh* corporate world to go earn a living being a corporate slave like all of the other losers...

This month's cover story is very, very ambitious. It's an attempt by adult journalists (all of us are over 25, some even over 40!) reading